

The Family Financial Checklist

Is your household organised and aligned?

Most families are not short of assets. They are short of a single, current picture of what they own, who it goes to, and who else knows. This checklist is about alignment rather than amounts — tick what is already true, and let the blanks decide what to do next.

Everything is written down in one place

- ☐ A single list exists of all bank accounts, deposits, mutual fund folios, demat holdings, small savings, provident fund and pension accounts.
- ☐ Property papers, loan documents, insurance policies and locker details are recorded with where the originals are kept.
- ☐ The list is reviewed once a year and dated, so the family knows it is current.

Nominations are complete and current

- ☐ Every bank account, folio, demat account, insurance policy, PF and pension account carries a nominee.
- ☐ Nominee names, relationships and dates of birth match across records — no blanks, no outdated entries after a marriage, birth or bereavement.
- ☐ The family understands that a nominee receives the money but a Will decides who it finally belongs to.

Protection is sized for the family, not the earner

- ☐ Term cover exists for everyone whose income the family depends on, and reflects current liabilities and years to retirement.
- ☐ Outstanding loans are covered, so no debt transfers to the family.
- ☐ Health cover includes every dependant, including parents where relevant.
- ☐ Premium due dates are known and paid from an account that will stay active.

At least one other person can find and act on all of it

- ☐ A spouse or adult child knows where records are kept and how to access them.
- ☐ Registered email, mobile number and bank mandates are consistent and belong to someone reachable.
- ☐ A Will is in place, or a date is set to make one.

If only one thing gets done this month

Check the nominations. It costs nothing, takes an afternoon, and it is the gap that causes families the most difficulty at the worst possible time.